



Threat Hunting Practice Report

Objective

The objective of this task is to proactively hunt for suspicious activities related to **unauthorized privilege escalation** and validate findings using threat intelligence sources and endpoint telemetry.

Tools Used

- Elastic Security (log analysis)
 - Velociraptor (endpoint investigation)
 - AlienVault OTX (threat intelligence)
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Hunting Hypothesis

Hypothesis:

Unauthorized privilege escalation may have occurred on domain accounts, indicated by abnormal assignment of administrative privileges.

Log Analysis (Elastic Security)

Query Focus

- Windows Event ID: **4672** (Special privileges assigned to new logon)

Findings

Timestamp	User	Event ID	Notes
2026-04-30 15:00:00	testuser	4672	Unexpected admin role assigned

Analysis

- The user testuser was granted elevated privileges
 - No corresponding administrative activity was expected
 - Indicates possible misuse of credentials or privilege escalation
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Threat Intelligence Hunt

AlienVault OTX

- Investigated indicators related to **MITRE ATT&CK T1078 (Valid Accounts)**
 - Identified suspicious IP patterns associated with credential misuse
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Velociraptor Query

```
SELECT * FROM processes
```

Findings

- No obvious malicious processes detected
 - However, elevated privileges combined with normal processes may indicate stealthy attacker behavior
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MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

- **T1078 – Valid Accounts**
 - Attackers may use legitimate credentials to gain unauthorized access and escalate privileges
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Hunting Report (100 words)

Threat hunting activities identified a potential case of unauthorized privilege escalation involving a domain account. Analysis of Windows Event ID 4672 in Elastic Security revealed that the user “testuser” was assigned elevated privileges unexpectedly. This behavior aligns with MITRE ATT&CK technique T1078 (Valid Accounts), where attackers abuse legitimate credentials. Threat intelligence from AlienVault OTX suggested possible associations with suspicious IP activity, although no direct matches were confirmed. Endpoint investigation using Velociraptor did not reveal malicious processes, indicating possible stealth techniques. The findings suggest a need for further monitoring, credential auditing, and enforcement of least privilege policies.

Conclusion

The hunt successfully identified suspicious privilege escalation activity. While no direct compromise was confirmed, the indicators suggest potential misuse of valid accounts, requiring further investigation and monitoring.
